Matthew Briney

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Museum and Cultural Institution Executive

Senior museum and cultural institution leader with a strong track record of advancing presidential libraries and historic sites through strategic vision, integrated planning, visitor-centered experiences, and measurable audience growth.

Results-oriented executive with deep experience leading complex, mission-driven organizations through strategic planning, large-scale initiatives, and cross-functional collaboration. Proven ability to translate institutional vision into executable roadmaps spanning exhibitions, visitor experience, education, operations, and public engagement. Adept at guiding organizations through periods of growth and change, leveraging data, audience insight, and sound judgment to inform decision-making and deliver measurable results. Hands-on, pragmatic leader with a strong record of building and motivating multidisciplinary teams to achieve shared goals and advance long-term organizational impact.

Areas of Expertise

- Museum Operations and Strategy
- Exhibitions, Interpretive Experiences
- Education and Civic Engagement
- Strategic Planning and Execution
- Leadership and Staff Development
- Budgeting, P&L, and Forecasting
- Project and Program Management
- Membership and Earned Revenue
- Public Programming and Events
- Institutional Communications
- Interpretive Storytelling
- Audience Development
- Analytics and Reporting
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Technology Implementation

Career Experience

Chief Communications & Marketing Officer, Theodore Roosevelt Presidential Library – Remote **2024 – Present**

Senior executive responsible for leading institutional communications and public-facing strategy for a presidential library under construction, working in close collaboration with executive leadership, operations, exhibitions, education, and development teams. Serve as a key member of the leadership team helping shape organizational vision, operational readiness, and public engagement in advance of opening. Oversee internal and external communications, press relations, and spokesperson duties for a fully remote, multi-city team, while building systems and processes that enable cross-department collaboration, clarity of messaging, and alignment across platforms.

- Served on the leadership team **responsible for developing the Library's operations plan**, including business and earned-revenue components, using benchmarking and planning data from peer presidential and cultural institutions.
- Led **a daily historical storytelling initiative** focused on Theodore Roosevelt's life and legacy, **tripling social media engagement** while using performance data to inform interpretation and audience engagement.
- Implemented internal collaboration and communication tools for a fully remote, multi-city team, improving cross-department coordination, visibility, and operational readiness.
- **Direct and manage all press relations** for the Presidential Library, overseeing an external agency and serving as institutional spokesperson while monitoring coverage, sentiment, and reach.
- **Developed and maintained an institution-wide talking points** framework covering construction, exhibitions, outreach, and Theodore Roosevelt's legacy, ensuring consistency across leadership and partners.
- **Oversee a documentary video team** capturing the Library's construction and development, producing interpretive and archival assets used for education, exhibitions, and public engagement.
- **Led the selection of ticketing, e-commerce, and database systems**, evaluating platforms for scalability, reporting capabilities, data integrity, and visitor experience.
- B**uild strategic partnerships with regional tourism organizations, government agencies, and education partners**, using referral and participation data to assess impact and drive visitation.
- **Established the Library's membership and annual giving programs**, defining value propositions and baseline metrics for acquisition, retention, and engagement.
- **Led the development of an AI-driven, GPT-powered collections platform**, working closely with collections and curatorial teams to improve access to and exploration of the Library's collection.
- Advised exhibitions and interpretive teams on permanent exhibition development, with **primary responsibility for shaping digital and interactive** components informed by audience research and visitor experience

Vice President, Media & Communications, George Washington's Mount Vernon – VA **2014 – 2024**

Senior executive at one of the nation's most visited historic sites, responsible for leading integrated communications, interpretive media, and public-facing initiatives in close coordination with museum leadership, curatorial, education, guest services, and operations teams. Oversee press relations, community engagement, and creative production across digital, print, photo, video, and design, while serving as a principal spokesperson for the estate. **Manage a $2.5M annual operating budget**, ensuring fiscally responsible planning, resource allocation, and alignment with institutional priorities.

- **Led website redesign for Mount Vernon**, prioritizing content marketing to enhance educational outreach and drive increased visitation via organic SEO impact, boosting annual visitation from **2.5M to 8M+ visitors**, with dwell time of **3.5 minutes**.
- Produced Mount Vernon's immersive virtual tour, **attracting 4M+ visitors with dwell time of 18 minutes**. Widely used in classrooms nationwide. Offered interactive exploration of estate via vivid HDR photography, stories, videos, and images.
- Achieved major growth in e-commerce revenue, **from $1.1M in 2015 to $8.6M** in 2021 by leading and completing strategic initiatives, leveraging innovative marketing strategies, and executing seamless online shopping experiences.
- **Directed end-to-end creation of award-winning Be Washington interactive theater**, **high-value $3.5M capital project**. Headed creation of theater's highly acclaimed online platform, widely utilized in classrooms across the country.
- Leveraged strong leadership abilities in overseeing estate's brand management, including leading Mount Vernon's graphic design team. Ensure consistent brand representation and aligned visual identity with organizational objectives.
- Functioned as an Executive producer of award-winning short films, including Yorktown Now or Never, The Winter Patriots, A More Perfect Union, Washington's War, and George Washington and the Pursuit for Religious Freedom. Films received Telly Awards and are distributed on major streaming platforms.
- Administered public affairs logistics for high-profile VVIP visits, including President Biden, President Trump, King Charles, Benjamin Netanyahu, and President Zelensky, ensuring seamless protocols and security arrangements.
- Led successful revamping of the estate's pricing models to enhance the value proposition of membership, leading to a 30% increase in new members within the first year by effectively attracting and retaining a larger base of supporters.
- Oversaw and coordinated a wide range of external filming activities, including but not limited to management of production schedules, preservation of historic structures and objects, licensing requirements, and logistics.
- **Gained recognition as recipient of Thea Outstanding Achievement Award** in 2018 for interactive theater Be Washington; a $3.5M, 36-seat theater that immerses visitors in decision-making scenarios as George Washington.
- **Drove impressive surge** in Mount Vernon's website visitation, driving annual visitors **from 4.1M in 2014 to an exceptional 9M in 2021**, almost doubling online engagement and expanding reach to a broader audience.
- Produced and managed estate's audio tour, including more than 75 stops and featuring a talented ensemble of 45 voice actors. Ensured multilingual accessibility by providing tours in 5 different languages.
- Ensured smooth implementation of a dynamic email revenue enhancement strategy, **accomplishing a 38% increase through meticulous segmentation**, rigorous A+B testing, and strategic mobile optimization.
- Devised, deployed, and directed multiple content marketing strategies to elevate organic SEO performance, resulting in numerous search terms ranking within the top 2-3 links in search listings.
- Spearheaded development and implementation of a custom e-commerce platform, enabling efficient management of ticket sales, donations, memberships, and donor retention.
- Steered end-to-end migration of Mount Vernon's web and database platforms to Amazon Web Services (AWS), yielding a **notable 35% reduction in operating costs**.
- Served as the editor of Mount Vernon magazine tasked with overseeing tri-annual publication featuring renowned scholars covering diverse topics and themes.
- Utilized strong technical skills in creating an innovative temporary augmented reality tour utilizing Epson Movierio glasses.
- Played a pivotal role in adoption of a centralized CRM system, including overseeing seamless integration across the estate.
- Optimized advertising expenditure aimed at generating trackable ROI campaigns delivering a 3.9% average conversion rate.

Vice President, Technical Manager, Edelman Public Relations – Washington, DC **2011 – 2014**

Orchestrated design and execution of Edelman's exclusive Salesforce.com database marketing platform, Multiplier, offering efficient engagement analytics spanning web, social, email, and offline initiatives, resulting in enhanced strategic decision-making. Delivered **strategic marketing insights** and technical guidance to prominent brands such as **HP, Hyundai, Microsoft, BlackBerry, GE, Shell, and Pepsi**, driving marketing success and industry competitiveness. Kept abreast of emerging technology trends, while integrating new resources into client campaigns, fostering innovation, and ensuring continuous process improvement. **Directed a global technical team and fostered strategic alliances** with technology vendors to ensure delivery of client specifications across **portfolio of 60+ projects**, improving overall client satisfaction and operational efficiency. Established robust reporting and analytics standards aimed at pinpointing crucial performance indicators for client campaigns across web, social, and email platforms.

- **Implemented and managed various grassroots advocacy campaigns** for a range of prominent organizations, including American Petroleum Institute, Pfizer, Microsoft, Walmart, Grocery Manufacturers of America, National Mining Association, Pepsi, Smarter Fuel Future, Embassy of Canada, Halliburton, Hilex, Episcopal Church, ASCD, and National Health Council.

- Hired by HP CEO Meg Whitman to lead internal communications amid rapid leadership changes. Created HPNN, internal news platform using native HP technologies. Facilitated C-suite news updates, bidirectional communication, and staff feedback.
- **Headed development and deployment of B2G (Business-to-Government) website** for BlackBerry RIM, highlighting robust security features of BlackBerry systems for secure government communications.
- **In 24 hours**, created interactive tool using Multiplier technology to tackle Hyundai's fuel economy miscalculation. Tool calculated MPG discrepancies by VIN, factoring in state-specific fuel prices, and allowed owners to file fuel reimbursement claims. **Offered 120% cash value as fair compensation** for misrepresentation, ahead of Hyundai's EPA hearing with competitors.
- Oversaw end-to-end creation and execution of a secure, white-label internal project management system akin to Basecamp, tailored to facilitate collaboration on confidential client projects.
- **Engineered bespoke digital publishing system for Chevron**, enabling safe and uninterrupted dissemination of information while prioritizing data confidentiality and employee privacy.
- **Designed a user-friendly internal communications tool using** Salesforce.com for seamless employee communication and collaboration within General Electric.
- **Developed cutting-edge popup event** for a leading ride-share competitor, Taxi Magic, that facilitated seamless app-based ordering of conventional taxi cabs.

Vice President, Emotive, LLC – **A**rlington, VA **2005 – 2011**

Pioneered establishment of an interactive direct marketing agency, leading from conceptualization to execution. Offered strategic marketing **consulting to 40+ prestigious non-profit organizations**, political candidates, and trade associations including Pickens Plan, Californians for Schwarzenegger, Alzheimer's Association, Republican National Committee, and the Washington DC Martin Luther King, Jr. National Memorial Project, enhancing their outreach and impact.

- Executed digital fundraising campaigns for high-profile political figures, including Governors (Schwarzenegger, Kasich, Green, Haslam), Senator McConnell, Senator Bennett, Senator Allen, the Republic National Committee, the National Republican Congressional Committee, the National Republican Senatorial Committee, and the Republican State Leadership Committee.
- Delineated growth verticals, created sales and marketing strategies, and managed product pricing and packaging for political, non-profit, and association-oriented products and services, leading to diversified revenue streams and enhanced market reach.
- Transformed open-source CRM system CiviCRM for political campaigns, while providing source code to enhance platform's email throughput via efficient server multi-threading, thereby improving operational efficiency and response times.
- Headed a digital marketing for **T. Boone Pickens' Pickens Plan campaign**, reducing US gasoline dependency. Managed Super Bowl campaign with live stream that **attracted millions, petition amassed 13M+ signatures**, expanding campaign reach.
- Managed and maintained emotive's technology alliances with Blackbaud Sphere, Blackbaud Convio 360, and Blackbaud Raiser's Edge, ensuring seamless integration and technological advancements.
- Designed and executed marketing and fundraising strategies for **the Martin Luther King, Jr. National Memorial** ceremony in Washington. Managed **digital ticketing and raised $15M+ through digital outreach**, contributing to financial goals.
- **Unified and spearheaded a multidisciplinary** team comprising account managers, graphic designers, and web application developers, fostering a high-performing work environment.
- **Amplified company's annual revenue to $1.6M** within a two-year timeline using robust growth and business acumen.
- **Generated annual revenue of $5.7M** through effective management and execution of business strategies.

Additional Experience

Director of Strategic Marketing, American International Automobile Dealers Association – Alexandria, VA

Web Properties Manager, DCI Group – Washington, DC

Education

Bachelor of Arts, Interdisciplinary Studies with minors in Communications, Graphic Design, and Humanities
Virginia Tech – Blacksburg, VA

Boards & Affiliations

Board Member, Secretary, Visit Fairfax (2019 – 2022)

Participating Member, Mount Vernon Tourism Taskforce (2019 – 2022)

Board Member, The Campagna Center – Alexandria (2013 – 2016)